

citizens—there will be global citizens and I think the 25 years show acknowledged that," he says.

With Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail Ltd now having a 51 per cent stake in the brand, the designer sees the move as an important one to empower the bottom and the middle of the pyramid. "It has allowed me to create insurance policies for not only people who work in my company but for their immediate families and spouses as well," he says, adding that theirs is a beautiful marriage where the corporate lets him lead the business and they strengthen the backend by being the wind beneath his wings. In the years to come, the designer wants to expand his brand, but not at the cost of integrity. "We will go wherever we think there is an important role for the brand to play...like beauty...probably hotels at some point of time," he says, adding that the best had always belonged to India but it was appropriated and plundered from us. "I want to spend the next 25 years bringing the respect back to India," he signs off. ■

–Deepali Dhingra

ART

HOME AND THE WORLD

A group art exhibition at **TRI Art & Culture, Kolkata,** offers an unconventional take on the concept of 'home'

The punctuation marks in South Kolkata gallery TRI Art & Culture's latest exhibition HOME?! underscore the comfort of the domestic space alongside questioning what it really entails. Decaying dining tables, mutant chairs and a suit made of paper in this mixed-media "surreal mimesis of interior spaces", as the curatorial note puts it, forces viewers to re-examine what makes a home, home.

The exhibition, curated by Lekha Poddar, brings together 20 artists working across painting, sculpture, textiles and photography. HOME?! encapsulates the entrepreneur and art patron's roots in Kolkata, as well as the year-old gallery space's earlier avatar as a private residence, now, a 70-year-old heritage property.

What's most striking about HOME?! is the range of artwork on display, all of which has been carefully curated to signal the exhibition's theme. On the ground floor, we open into the dining room with Sri Lankan artist Anoli Perera's 'Dinner for Six (Inside Out)', that combines her ancestral teak dining table with cloth nets, giving the impression of a cobwebbed, forlorn dinner scene. Beside it is Prajakta Potnis's 'Porous Walls-4', where a dysfunctional, metal ceiling fan is overwhelmed with plastic termite eggs. "For a long time, I wanted to curate an exhibition around these works which I thought would fit perfectly in a home setting," says Poddar. "This exhibition is a surrealist take on home, where none of these artworks can be used practically."

HOME?!, curated by Lekha Poddar from the collection of her Devi Art Foundation, will be on at TRI till March 30

The first floor, containing the study and bedroom, displays multiple artworks, which include Sudarshan Shetty's mobile furniture work; Udeya Vir Singh's 'No One's Chair', a mutant put together using broken limbs of various wooden chairs; Mithu Sen's overwhelming 'Burnt by the Sun', consisting of an illuminated black silk veil punctured by incense stick marks that convey the story of Behula from Shivapurana, in Bengali; and Anita Dube's haunting suit made out of paper stained to suggest an immaterial presence wearing it. In conjunction with the exhibition, TRI is hosting various home-themed events, including experiential meals, choreographed enactments and an artist panel. ■

–Devarsi Ghosh





INSIDE JOB The HOME?! exhibition; (Left) 'Dinner for Six', mixed media by Anoli Perera